

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Biotechnology English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For biotech scientists, translational researchers, assay-development teams, platform teams, program managers, alliance managers, business-development staff, and biotech executives.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

02 Assay Development and Reproducibility

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

03 Biomarkers and Translational Strategy

Clarify missing information before responding.

04 Preclinical Data Packages

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

06 IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

07 Investor and Board Updates

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

08 Partnering and Business Development

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A platform produces a promising signal in one experimental system. An investor slide says it will work across several diseases.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

platform - A foundational technology or system that supports several applications or products.

modality - A type of therapeutic or technological approach, such as a small molecule or cell therapy.

proof of concept - Early evidence that an idea can work under specified conditions.

translatability - Likelihood that a finding in one model, setting, or population will predict results in the intended real-world or clinical setting.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One experimental system, not several diseases

Fictional platform review: a signal was observed in one experimental system, while an investor slide claims broad disease applicability.

01 • Scientific founder: The slide says our platform will work across several diseases. Does the experiment establish that?

02 • Research lead: No. We observed a promising signal in one system, not broad disease translatability.

03 • Scientific founder: Could we call it proof of concept while keeping the broader opportunity visible?

04 • Research lead: Yes, if we define exactly what concept and experimental setting the evidence supports.

05 • Scientific founder: The modality is the same across the proposed programs. Doesn't that reduce the uncertainty?

06 • Research lead: It may inform our hypothesis, but a shared modality doesn't demonstrate the same outcome everywhere.

07 • Scientific founder: How should I describe the broader thesis without presenting the future work as completed?

08 • Research lead: Call it a development hypothesis and identify the additional systems we still need to study.

09 • Scientific founder: I'll narrow the claim and keep the observed result separate from the proposed applications.

10 • Research lead: I'll review the experimental description so the platform story remains ambitious without overstating the evidence.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A delivery result is not a therapeutic outcome

Separate fictional research discussion: a platform delivered a reporter into a laboratory cell model; no therapeutic payload or patient outcome was tested.

01 • Business lead: The reporter entered the cells. Can we say the therapeutic modality has demonstrated benefit?

02 • Platform scientist: No. This experiment evaluated delivery of a reporter, not a therapeutic payload or patient outcome.

03 • Business lead: Then what part of the platform thesis does the result actually support?

04 • Platform scientist: A specific delivery capability in this cell model under the tested conditions.

05 • Business lead: Could we describe that as a limited proof of concept rather than a failed therapeutic study?

06 • Platform scientist: Exactly. The study didn't ask the therapeutic question, so neither success nor failure on that question is established.

07 • Business lead: What should we say about translatability when partners ask whether it will work clinically?

08 • Platform scientist: That remains to be investigated. Explain the evidence boundary and the proposed next questions.

09 • Business lead: I'll use a delivery-specific headline and remove the implied patient-benefit claim.

10 • Platform scientist: Good. I'll keep the reporter, model, and experimental scope explicit in the supporting explanation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An observed effect with an uncertain mechanism

Separate fictional platform meeting: an experimental effect is repeatable within the supplied study, but the proposed mechanism has not been isolated.

01 • Program director: The effect repeated. Can we now tell the board that our proposed mechanism is confirmed?

02 • Discovery scientist: The repeated observation supports the effect in this study, but the mechanism hasn't been isolated.

03 • Program director: Isn't reproducing an effect the same as explaining why it occurs in the system?

04 • Discovery scientist: No. An observation and a causal explanation require different evidence, even when the observation is consistent.

05 • Program director: How do we avoid making the platform sound directionless while preserving that distinction?

06 • Discovery scientist: Present the mechanism as our working thesis and explain the tests intended to distinguish alternative explanations.

07 • Program director: Should we change the modality description because the mechanism remains uncertain?

08 • Discovery scientist: Only if the description itself is inaccurate. Don't revise established terminology simply to mask an evidence gap.

09 • Program director: I'll separate the repeatable effect from the unconfirmed explanation on the slide.

10 • Discovery scientist: I'll review those statements and keep any claim about broader translatability explicitly provisional.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

A platform produces a promising signal in one experimental system. An investor slide says it will work across several diseases.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The finding is promising in this experimental system. We have not established its relevance across diseases. I'll distinguish the current evidence from the broader platform hypothesis.

Scenario 2 | A platform claim based on one successful payload

A fictional platform delivered payload A in one test system. Payloads B and C have not been tested. Discuss a partner-facing explanation of what is demonstrated and what remains a platform hypothesis.

Role A: Platform scientist: describe the tested payload and limit the proof-of-concept claim.

Role B: Business development manager: ask how to explain the broader opportunity without claiming universal delivery.

Possible opening: We demonstrated delivery of payload A in this system; the other payloads remain untested.

Success checks

- State the tested scope accurately.
- Separate the platform thesis from evidence of broad applicability.
- Agree a qualified statement and the next unanswered experimental question.

Add a complication: A partner asks you to call the platform payload-independent today.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Assay Development and Reproducibility

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

An assay gives consistent results within one run but different results across three days. A colleague calls it fully reproducible.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

assay - Laboratory procedure used to measure the presence, amount, activity, or quality of a biological target.

sensitivity - Ability of a test, model, or process to correctly identify true positives or detect a change in an input.

specificity - Ability of a test, model, or process to correctly identify true negatives and avoid false positives.

reproducibility - Obtaining consistent results using the same data and methods; conventions vary by research field.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - B. An increase of one percentage point.
 - C. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Within-run consistency versus between-day reproducibility

Fictional assay review: results are consistent within one run but differ across three days; no cause has been established.

01 • Assay scientist: The repeats agree within one run. Can we describe the assay as fully reproducible?

02 • Quality scientist: Not yet. Results differ across three days, so the within-run evidence doesn't cover that variability.

03 • Assay scientist: Should we compare the daily averages alone to choose the best-performing day?

04 • Quality scientist: We should compare the runs under the same criteria and inspect controls and conditions, not select a favorable day.

05 • Assay scientist: What tradeoff should we explain if a faster method has only within-run testing?

06 • Quality scientist: It may save time per run, but between-day reproducibility remains an unresolved part of the assessment.

07 • Assay scientist: Would stronger sensitivity automatically outweigh that uncertainty for every intended assay use?

08 • Quality scientist: No. The intended use and agreed performance criteria determine what evidence is relevant.

09 • Assay scientist: I'll present within-run consistency separately and compare the three days transparently.

10 • Quality scientist: I'll review the comparison plan without assigning a cause or declaring the assay fully reproducible in advance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A sensitivity comparison at different thresholds

Separate fictional assay discussion: method A and method B were evaluated using different positivity thresholds and different sample panels.

01 • Laboratory manager: Method A has the higher reported sensitivity. Should we choose it over method B?

02 • Assay developer: The thresholds and sample panels differ, so those headline results aren't a fair comparison yet.

03 • Laboratory manager: Could we keep each method's preferred threshold and simply rank the reported percentages?

04 • Assay developer: We need a justified comparison under the intended-use criteria, with threshold choices and sample differences visible.

05 • Laboratory manager: What else belongs beside sensitivity when we explain the options to the team?

06 • Assay developer: Specificity and reproducibility, plus practical requirements such as sample needs and turnaround time.

07 • Laboratory manager: We don't have comparable values for all those measures in this exercise.

08 • Assay developer: Then mark them unknown. Don't assume an unreported characteristic favors either method.

09 • Laboratory manager: I'll request a common evaluation plan before describing A as the superior assay.

10 • Assay developer: I'll outline the comparison and explain the tradeoffs without treating one attractive metric as the whole decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Faster preparation with a sample-volume tradeoff

Separate fictional assay selection: method C uses half the preparation time but twice the sample volume of method D; comparable analytical performance is not yet established.

01 • Research operations lead: Method C is faster. Can we replace method D for all samples next week?

02 • Assay scientist: C halves preparation time but needs twice the sample volume; analytical comparability is still unestablished.

03 • Research operations lead: So the operational advantage may matter differently when the available sample is limited?

04 • Assay scientist: Exactly. We should compare both methods for the same intended samples and performance criteria.

05 • Research operations lead: Could we assume equal specificity because both methods measure the same target?

06 • Assay scientist: No. A shared target doesn't establish equal analytical performance or reproducibility.

07 • Research operations lead: I'll show preparation time and sample volume as known differences, with performance marked pending.

08 • Assay scientist: Please also avoid presenting the proposed replacement date as an approved method change.

09 • Research operations lead: Agreed. I'll ask the review team which comparison evidence is needed before a decision.

10 • Assay scientist: I'll prepare that assessment so the eventual choice reflects the actual tradeoff rather than speed alone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Assay Development and Reproducibility

An assay gives consistent results within one run but different results across three days. A colleague calls it fully reproducible.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: Within-run consistency and performance across days are different questions. Let's report both and investigate the between-day variation before describing the assay as reproducible under those conditions.

Scenario 2 | A method tested by only one operator

A fictional assay has consistent results from one operator. A second method has data from three operators, but the two studies used different samples. Compare the evidence needed before claiming the first method is equally reproducible.

Role A: Assay lead: explain the scope of the single-operator evidence.

Role B: Laboratory reviewer: request a comparison using aligned samples and operator conditions.

Possible opening: Our result supports consistency for one operator, not yet the broader operator comparison.

Success checks

- Keep within-operator and across-operator evidence distinct.
- Identify the different sample sets as a comparison limitation.
- Agree common criteria without inventing results for untested conditions.

Add a complication: The team wants to treat the untested operators as equivalent without checking.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Biomarkers and Translational Strategy

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A team calls a biomarker "validated" without specifying whether it means analytical performance or clinical usefulness.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

biomarker - Measurable biological characteristic used to indicate a condition, response, exposure, or disease-related process.

patient stratification - Grouping patients by characteristics that may affect disease course, treatment response, safety, or trial analysis.

surrogate endpoint - Measure expected to predict clinical benefit but not itself a direct measure of how a patient feels, functions, or survives.

validation - Confirming that an output or system meets needs for its intended use under defined conditions.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

What does validated mean here?

Fictional biomarker meeting: a slide calls a biomarker validated without identifying analytical performance or clinical usefulness.

01 • Translational lead: The slide says validated. Do you mean analytical performance or usefulness in a clinical decision?

02 • Biomarker scientist: The wording doesn't specify that, so we should check the underlying evidence before presenting it.

03 • Translational lead: Could the audience assume the biomarker is ready for patient stratification in a trial?

04 • Biomarker scientist: Yes, and that may go beyond what the actual validation work supports.

05 • Translational lead: What precise question should we ask the team that supplied the slide?

06 • Biomarker scientist: Which intended use, performance characteristics, and evidence support the word validated?

07 • Translational lead: Should we call it a surrogate endpoint while we wait for their response?

08 • Biomarker scientist: No. That introduces another claim requiring its own context and supporting evidence.

09 • Translational lead: I'll mark the validation scope as awaiting clarification and remove any implied clinical readiness.

10 • Biomarker scientist: I'll request the source assessment and help restate the claim within the scope it actually establishes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Stratification or eligibility?

Separate fictional trial-design rehearsal: a biomarker is labeled for patient stratification, but a recruitment draft says people without it cannot enroll.

01 • Clinical operations lead: The recruitment draft excludes people without the marker. Is that what stratification means in this plan?

02 • Translational scientist: Not necessarily. We need to clarify whether the marker defines eligibility or grouping within the study.

03 • Clinical operations lead: The supplied design note only says patient stratification, so the exclusion isn't confirmed.

04 • Translational scientist: Correct. Ask the protocol owner which intended use is specified before communicating eligibility.

05 • Clinical operations lead: Could analytical validation of the biomarker settle that design question for us?

06 • Translational scientist: No. Assay performance doesn't itself determine how the protocol uses the result.

07 • Clinical operations lead: I'll flag the mismatch and ask for the exact approved recruitment instruction.

08 • Translational scientist: Please preserve the two source passages so the reviewer can see the different meanings.

09 • Clinical operations lead: Until then, I'll avoid telling sites that the marker is a confirmed exclusion criterion.

10 • Translational scientist: Good. We'll distinguish measuring the biomarker from the authorized decision about how it is used.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A biomarker change is not automatically a surrogate endpoint

Separate fictional translational review: an exploratory biomarker changed after exposure; no relationship to clinical outcomes has been established.

01 • Program manager: The biomarker changed. Can we describe it as a validated surrogate endpoint now?

02 • Biomarker lead: What evidence are you using for surrogate status? This case only establishes an exploratory biomarker change.

03 • Program manager: I assumed a measurable response could stand in for a clinical outcome.

04 • Biomarker lead: That is the distinction we need to clarify. A measurement change doesn't automatically establish that relationship.

05 • Program manager: Which intended use should the presentation name while the relationship remains unestablished?

06 • Biomarker lead: Exploratory measurement in the studied setting, with the clinical interpretation explicitly unresolved.

07 • Program manager: Should we ask the analysis team whether analytical validation has been completed as a separate question?

08 • Biomarker lead: Yes. Keep assay performance and the clinical relevance of the marker as separate evidence questions.

09 • Program manager: I'll remove the surrogate claim and request the scope of each available assessment.

10 • Biomarker lead: I'll help review the wording so a useful exploratory finding isn't turned into an unsupported clinical conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Biomarkers and Translational Strategy

A team calls a biomarker "validated" without specifying whether it means analytical performance or clinical usefulness.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What kind of validation do you mean here? Could we distinguish the assay's analytical performance from evidence about the biomarker's clinical use? The slide needs to state which claim the data support.

Scenario 2 | A cutoff borrowed from another study

A fictional project proposes using a biomarker cutoff from a different study. The populations and measurement methods have not been compared. Hold a clarification conversation about what the cutoff is intended to do in the new project.

Role A: Translational scientist: ask whether the cutoff is exploratory, stratification-related, or proposed for eligibility.

Role B: Clinical project lead: identify the unresolved comparison and request the appropriate review.

Possible opening: Before we borrow this cutoff, could you clarify its intended use in our study?

Success checks

- Clarify the proposed use before discussing adoption.
- Identify population and method comparability as unknown.
- Avoid claiming validation transfers automatically between studies.

Add a complication: A colleague says published means validated for every new population.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Preclinical Data Packages

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An animal study shows an effect at one tested exposure. A summary describes the result as proof of human benefit.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

in vitro - Performed outside a living organism, typically in a laboratory vessel, cell system, or controlled assay.

in vivo - Performed in a living organism, such as an animal or human study participant.

toxicity - The capacity of a substance or exposure to cause harmful biological effects.

safety margin - The difference between a limit and an observed or expected value under a stated definition.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An animal result with a human-benefit overclaim

Fictional preclinical review: an animal study found an effect at one exposure; the summary calls it proof of human benefit.

01 • Preclinical lead: The summary says proof of human benefit. Our study was in animals at one tested exposure.

02 • Medical writer: Could we keep proof of benefit and place in vivo in the methods line?

03 • Preclinical lead: That still invites a human interpretation. The claim itself must identify the experimental scope.

04 • Medical writer: What can we state positively without turning the observed effect into clinical evidence?

05 • Preclinical lead: Describe the effect in the tested animal model and qualify the unresolved human relevance.

06 • Medical writer: Should I add a reassuring statement about toxicity or safety margin to balance the uncertainty?

07 • Preclinical lead: Not unless the relevant assessment is supplied. This result doesn't establish those conclusions.

08 • Medical writer: I'll remove the human-benefit claim and keep the exposure limitation beside the finding.

09 • Preclinical lead: Please distinguish any in vitro support from this in vivo observation as well.

10 • Medical writer: I will. The revised summary will explain the evidence we have without filling missing clinical or safety information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

No observed toxicity in a limited experiment

Separate fictional preclinical exercise: no toxicity finding was observed in one short study; longer exposure and other study conditions have not been assessed.

01 • Program lead: No toxicity was observed. Can the board slide say the candidate is safe?

02 • Toxicology scientist: That is broader than the evidence. The observation applies to this study and its limited conditions.

03 • Program lead: Would saying completely safe preclinically be more accurate than implying patient safety?

04 • Toxicology scientist: No. Completely still goes beyond a single short study and the untested conditions.

05 • Program lead: How should we preserve the useful finding without turning uncertainty into an alarm?

06 • Toxicology scientist: State what was observed, the scope assessed, and what remains outside that scope.

07 • Program lead: Can we calculate a safety margin from this statement alone for the presentation?

08 • Toxicology scientist: No. The needed exposure and comparison information isn't supplied in this exercise.

09 • Program lead: I'll use no toxicity finding observed in this study and keep the limitations visible.

10 • Toxicology scientist: I'll review the exact wording against the report so the negative finding isn't presented as a universal assurance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two model results should not be blended into one claim

Separate fictional data-package discussion: an in vitro study shows an effect, while an in vivo study result is inconclusive; reasons for the difference are unknown.

01 • Research director: Can we summarize both studies as positive overall since the cell experiment showed an effect?

02 • Preclinical scientist: The in vivo result is inconclusive. Combining them that way would conceal an important difference.

03 • Research director: Does inconclusive mean the animal study disproved the platform's proposed mechanism?

04 • Preclinical scientist: No. It means the supplied result doesn't support a definite conclusion; the explanation remains unknown.

05 • Research director: What should we say when the team asks why the two models differ?

06 • Preclinical scientist: List the difference as unresolved and identify the evidence needed to investigate, without naming a cause.

07 • Research director: Could exposure differences be mentioned as a possibility rather than an established finding?

08 • Preclinical scientist: Yes, clearly as a question to assess, not as the explanation already demonstrated.

09 • Research director: I'll show the in vitro and in vivo findings separately in the package review.

10 • Preclinical scientist: Good. We'll preserve both observations and avoid turning an incomplete comparison into either proof or disproof of clinical benefit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Preclinical Data Packages

An animal study shows an effect at one tested exposure. A summary describes the result as proof of human benefit.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The result describes the tested animal model and exposure. It does not establish human benefit. I'll state the finding and the limits on translating it to a clinical setting.

Scenario 2 | A safety-margin figure without its comparison

A fictional preclinical slide lists a safety margin of five but omits the exposure measure and comparison basis. No underlying values are supplied. Discuss how to qualify the slide before it is presented.

Role A: Toxicology reviewer: ask for the missing basis of the calculation.

Role B: Program presenter: explain that the number cannot yet support a broader safety statement.

Possible opening: The figure five needs its exposure measure and comparison basis before we can interpret it.

Success checks

- Request the missing calculation context.
- Avoid converting the ratio into an unsupported patient-safety claim.
- Agree to verify the source or leave the interpretation unresolved.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks you to translate the number into five times safer for patients.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A process transfer achieved the expected yield in two small runs. Performance at a larger scale remains untested.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

CMC - Chemistry, manufacturing, and controls information that shows how a drug substance or product is made and consistently controlled.

yield - The proportion of production meeting defined requirements; in finance, a return measure with a different calculation.

comparability - The extent to which products, processes, or results are sufficiently similar for a stated purpose.

tech transfer - Controlled transfer of product, process, method, or manufacturing knowledge between teams, sites, or organizations.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two small runs do not complete scale-up

Fictional technology-transfer update: two small runs met the expected yield, while larger-scale performance is untested.

01 • Program manager: Both runs met the yield expectation. Can I mark scale-up complete on the CMC dashboard?

02 • Process scientist: No. Those were two small runs; performance at the larger scale remains untested.

03 • Program manager: What completed milestone can I report without minimizing the progress from the transfer team?

04 • Process scientist: The small-run yield objective was met twice. Larger-scale evaluation is still pending.

05 • Program manager: Does matching yield mean product comparability has also been established for the transferred process?

06 • Process scientist: Not from yield alone. Comparability requires the relevant assessment, which isn't established in this case.

07 • Program manager: I'll separate tech-transfer activity, observed yield, and outstanding scale-up evidence in the update.

08 • Process scientist: Please also avoid turning the planned larger run into a guaranteed supply date.

09 • Program manager: Agreed. I'll ask for the next confirmed readiness checkpoint instead of declaring manufacturing ready.

10 • Process scientist: I'll provide the current dependencies and distinguish completed work from results we have not yet generated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A transferred procedure without a receiving-site run

Separate fictional tech-transfer meeting: the receiving team has the process documents and completed training, but has not executed a run.

01 • Transfer coordinator: The receiving site has the documents and training. Is the transferred process now demonstrated there?

02 • Receiving scientist: Not yet. We haven't executed a run, so receiving-site performance remains untested.

03 • Transfer coordinator: Could the dashboard say transfer complete because all documents were delivered on schedule?

04 • Receiving scientist: It can say document delivery and training complete, but that shouldn't imply demonstrated process performance.

05 • Transfer coordinator: What should I tell the CMC lead about yield and comparability at the new site?

06 • Receiving scientist: They remain to be assessed; no receiving-site result is supplied here.

07 • Transfer coordinator: Should I use the originating site's yield as though it were our first result?

08 • Receiving scientist: No. It is source-site context, not an observation from the receiving site's process.

09 • Transfer coordinator: I'll keep those evidence sources separate and identify the pending execution stage.

10 • Receiving scientist: I'll confirm the readiness assessment for that stage and report results only after the appropriate work is completed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A yield result with quality review still pending

Separate fictional CMC exercise: a pilot run met its yield target, but the associated quality-attribute review remains open.

01 • Operations lead: The pilot yield met target. Can we call the run fully successful in the board update?

02 • CMC scientist: We can confirm the yield result, but the quality-attribute review is still open.

03 • Operations lead: Isn't yield the main measure of whether the process produced enough material?

04 • CMC scientist: It addresses quantity, but it doesn't by itself establish the relevant quality characteristics or comparability.

05 • Operations lead: How should the update explain the remaining work without suggesting a confirmed quality defect?

06 • CMC scientist: Say yield met target and quality review is pending. Pending is neither a pass nor a failure.

07 • Operations lead: Could we promise the material for the next activity while the review continues?

08 • CMC scientist: Only through the authorized decision process; our current evidence doesn't establish availability.

09 • Operations lead: I'll report the completed measurement and keep the dependent milestone conditional.

10 • CMC scientist: I'll return the verified review status and explain any implications once the assessment is actually available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech

A process transfer achieved the expected yield in two small runs. Performance at a larger scale remains untested.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The two small runs met the expected yield. Larger-scale performance is still untested. I'll present scale-up as an open question and identify the next planned evidence point.

Scenario 2 | A scale-up run postponed before execution

A fictional larger-scale run was scheduled for Monday but was not executed because equipment readiness was unconfirmed. Two earlier small runs remain the only yield evidence. Give a spoken status update and agree the next planning checkpoint.

Role A: CMC project lead: distinguish the missed activity from an unsuccessful experimental result.

Role B: Portfolio manager: ask which readiness confirmation is needed before a new schedule is proposed.

Possible opening: The larger run did not occur, so we have no new scale-up performance result to report.

Success checks

- Distinguish not executed from failed performance.
- Preserve the two small runs as the existing evidence boundary.
- Agree a readiness check without inventing a new execution date.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to label the postponed run a yield failure.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

Two partners want to exchange materials. The draft arrangement leaves publication and permitted-use questions unresolved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

IP - Intellectual property: legally recognized rights in certain creations, inventions, and identifying marks.

freedom to operate - Assessment of whether a product or activity can proceed without infringing another party's enforceable intellectual-property rights.

material transfer agreement - An agreement setting conditions for transferring and using research materials.

publication rights - The agreed rights and conditions governing disclosure or publication of work.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Clarify permitted use before sending materials

Fictional collaboration discussion: material exchange for assay testing is proposed, but permitted use and publication rights remain unresolved; an internal planning call is Friday.

01 • Collaboration scientist: Please arrange appropriate legal review of permitted use and publication rights before we commit to exchanging the materials.

02 • Alliance manager: I can coordinate that. Which proposed activity should the material transfer agreement review cover?

03 • Collaboration scientist: Assay testing. Please also confirm when an initial status update is feasible for Friday's planning call.

04 • Alliance manager: I'll check reviewer availability today; I can't promise the legal assessment will be complete by Friday.

05 • Collaboration scientist: A confirmed review plan would help. We need the open conditions visible before discussing transfer timing.

06 • Alliance manager: Could an email between the scientists substitute for resolving those conditions in the meantime?

07 • Collaboration scientist: We shouldn't assume that. Please keep the exchange conditional on the authorized review.

08 • Alliance manager: Understood. I'll coordinate the scoped review and return an availability update, not an approval promise.

09 • Collaboration scientist: Thank you. Material access also shouldn't be presented as a freedom-to-operate assurance.

10 • Alliance manager: Agreed. That separate question stays with the appropriate reviewers, and I'll distinguish both review statuses.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Publication review versus publication permission

Separate fictional academic-industry negotiation: one draft clause says publication review, another says prior permission; the intended arrangement is not agreed.

01 • Academic liaison: These clauses use review and prior permission differently. Could we clarify the intended publication process?

02 • Partnership manager: Yes. We shouldn't assume the two phrases create the same arrangement for the collaboration.

03 • Academic liaison: What should the legal reviewers receive so they can address the actual concern?

04 • Partnership manager: The conflicting clauses, proposed publication workflow, and each partner's stated questions about publication rights.

05 • Academic liaison: Could we tell the researchers they may publish immediately while the wording is being discussed?

06 • Partnership manager: No. We haven't confirmed the applicable arrangement or authority to make that commitment.

07 • Academic liaison: I'll request a joint clarification session before the next project planning call.

08 • Partnership manager: Please distinguish protection of confidential IP from any unagreed right to block publication.

09 • Academic liaison: I will frame both as issues for authorized review, not offer an interpretation as settled law.

10 • Partnership manager: Good. I'll coordinate the reviewers and return a confirmed process rather than leave scientists to infer the meaning.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A patent search is not a freedom-to-operate opinion

Separate fictional collaboration preparation: a quick patent-title search found no match for a proposed assay collaboration. No specialist freedom-to-operate review has occurred; the partner planning call is Thursday.

01 • Research director: Our quick title search found no match. Can we tell the partner there is no IP risk?

02 • Technology transfer officer: No. That search is not a freedom-to-operate assessment, and titles alone don't settle the question.

03 • Research director: Please arrange qualified review of the proposed assay collaboration and confirm what scope information the reviewer needs.

04 • Technology transfer officer: I'll coordinate that request. Please provide the current activity description rather than just the search result.

05 • Research director: I'll provide it today. Could you confirm when an initial review-plan update is feasible before Thursday's call?

06 • Technology transfer officer: I can check availability today, but I can't promise a completed opinion or favorable conclusion by Thursday.

07 • Research director: Understood. The immediate request is a scoped review plan and timing estimate, not a clearance statement.

08 • Technology transfer officer: Yes. I'll return the coordination update and flag any missing information for the reviewer.

09 • Research director: I'll keep the partner message clear that the preliminary search doesn't establish freedom to operate.

10 • Technology transfer officer: Good. Review coordination is accepted; the legal outcome remains unconfirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration

Two partners want to exchange materials. The draft arrangement leaves publication and permitted-use questions unresolved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could the responsible teams confirm the permitted uses and publication terms before the exchange? I'll summarize the scientific purpose and the unresolved questions for review.

Scenario 2 | A collaborator requests a new use

A fictional material transfer agreement is under review for assay testing. The collaborator now asks to use the material in a separate screening project. That additional use has not been reviewed. Hold a call requesting a precise scope assessment.

Role A: Alliance scientist: identify the additional proposed use and request review before commitment.

Role B: Technology transfer manager: ask for the new project's purpose and route the scope question to authorized reviewers.

Possible opening: The screening project is a new proposed use, so we need it reviewed rather than assume assay testing covers it.

Success checks

- Separate possession of material from confirmed permitted use.
- Make a specific request for scope review.
- Avoid giving a legal conclusion or promising approval.

Add a complication: The collaborator says the material is already on-site and therefore any use is allowed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Investor and Board Updates

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A project update lists completed experiments but does not connect them to the next funding milestone.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

milestone - A significant planned point or achievement used to track progress.

runway - In business, the time resources are expected to last under stated assumptions; in aviation, a takeoff and landing surface.

inflection point - A stage at which the direction or pace of development may change significantly.

risk mitigation - Action intended to reduce the likelihood or impact of a risk.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Completed experiments versus the funding milestone

Fictional board preparation: three assay runs at site A met the within-site criterion. The next funding-review milestone requires reviewed evidence from both sites A and B; site B has not run the assay, and funding is not guaranteed.

01 • Chief executive: Three runs met the criterion at site A. Have we reached the funding milestone?

02 • Program lead: Not yet. The milestone requires reviewed evidence from both sites, and site B hasn't run the assay.

03 • Chief executive: So completed within-site work is progress, but it doesn't establish between-site performance?

04 • Program lead: Exactly. Site A's result addresses one question; the second site's evidence remains missing.

05 • Chief executive: Can I describe this as all technical risk removed before the board discusses funding?

06 • Program lead: No. That would hide the untested site and overstate what those three runs establish.

07 • Chief executive: Then today's status is site A criterion met, site B work pending, milestone not yet achieved.

08 • Program lead: Correct. Completing the eventual milestone would support funding review, not guarantee financing or extend runway automatically.

09 • Chief executive: I'll separate the scientific achievement, remaining evidence, and financial assumptions in the update.

10 • Program lead: I'll bring the site B planning questions so the board can discuss the next decision with that gap visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A milestone reached with a remaining uncertainty

Separate fictional board exercise: a predefined assay milestone is achieved, but between-site performance remains untested and was outside that milestone's scope.

01 • Board presenter: We achieved the assay milestone. Can I say the program's technical risk has been removed?

02 • Research lead: No. That milestone covered a defined scope; between-site performance remains untested.

03 • Board presenter: So achieving the milestone and completing all risk mitigation are not the same statement?

04 • Research lead: Exactly. A milestone can be achieved while important follow-up questions remain.

05 • Board presenter: How do I describe the achievement without letting the limitation erase its value?

06 • Research lead: State the agreed criterion was met, then explain the next unresolved question and its significance.

07 • Board presenter: Could we call it an inflection point if the board hasn't discussed the decision impact?

08 • Research lead: Explain the impact first. Don't use the label as a substitute for the actual change in evidence.

09 • Board presenter: I'll show the achieved milestone beside the remaining between-site assessment.

10 • Research lead: I'll prepare that distinction and keep any next funding decision separate from the completed scientific criterion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Runway under two spending assumptions

Separate fictional finance rehearsal: current cash supports nine months at one planned spending rate and six months at a higher proposed rate; neither plan is selected.

01 • Scientific founder: Can the investor update simply say we have nine months of runway?

02 • Finance director: Only with its assumption. The higher proposed spending rate gives six months, and no plan is selected.

03 • Scientific founder: Is runway a fixed date in the accounts rather than a planning estimate?

04 • Finance director: It is an estimate tied to cash and spending assumptions, so the stated scenario matters.

05 • Scientific founder: Could we present nine months as a commitment while describing the expanded experiments separately?

06 • Finance director: That would disconnect the activity plan from its financial assumption and could mislead the audience.

07 • Scientific founder: I'll explain both scenarios and their relationship to the next scientific milestone.

08 • Finance director: Good. Don't assume that reaching that milestone guarantees new financing in either scenario.

09 • Scientific founder: I'll keep funding prospects separate and ask the board which plan it wants to consider.

10 • Finance director: I'll provide the scoped estimates and identify the assumptions that need updating before a decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Investor and Board Updates

A project update lists completed experiments but does not connect them to the next funding milestone.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: I'll group the results around the milestone question: what have we learned, what remains uncertain, and what evidence is needed next? That will make the funding discussion easier to follow.

Scenario 2 | A milestone date moved without new results

A fictional program moves its target milestone from June to August because a study is rescheduled. No new result exists. Explain the difference between a planning change and a scientific setback in a board conversation.

Role A: Program leader: report the changed date and unchanged evidence status.

Role B: Board representative: ask about dependencies and runway implications without assuming them.

Possible opening: The milestone date moved because the study was rescheduled; we have no new scientific result to interpret.

Success checks

- Separate schedule change from experimental outcome.
- Identify financial and milestone implications as questions requiring assessment.
- Agree the next verified planning update without predicting a result.

Add a complication: A stakeholder wants the update to call the delay proof the technology does not work.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Partnering and Business Development

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A potential partner requests exclusive rights before the scope of the collaboration is defined.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

term sheet - A summary of proposed transaction terms, whose binding effect depends on its wording and context.

option - A possible course of action; in an agreement, a specified right that may be exercised.

exclusivity - An arrangement limiting specified rights or activities to one party for an agreed scope.

due diligence - Structured review of facts, risks, obligations, and evidence before a transaction, onboarding, investment, or decision.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
 - C. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - B. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
 - C. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Define the collaboration before discussing exclusivity

Fictional partnering call: a prospective partner requests exclusive rights before the collaboration's scope is defined.

01 • Business development director: We understand your interest in exclusivity, but the collaboration scope is still undefined.

02 • Partnering lead: Could you agree to exclusive rights now and settle the details during due diligence?

03 • Business development director: We need to clarify the proposed field, activities, and duration before evaluating that commitment.

04 • Partnering lead: What can we discuss today that keeps the opportunity moving without that broad agreement?

05 • Business development director: A scoped diligence discussion and the information each side needs to assess a potential term sheet.

06 • Partnering lead: Would an option be another structure to explore once those boundaries are clearer?

07 • Business development director: Possibly, subject to commercial and legal review. I'm not offering agreed option terms today.

08 • Partnering lead: Then I'll describe the scope we are seeking and separate it from a final rights request.

09 • Business development director: We'll review that proposal and identify which conditions require further negotiation.

10 • Partnering lead: Agreed. Today's outcome is a defined next discussion, not an implied exclusivity commitment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A narrow diligence window instead of broad silence

Separate fictional negotiation: a partner wants a six-month halt to all partnering discussions; the proposed project concerns one research field only.

01 • Alliance director: Your request covers all partnering discussions for six months, but this project concerns one research field.

02 • Partner representative: We want enough time for due diligence without competing negotiations distracting the scientific team.

03 • Alliance director: Could we discuss a narrower scope and defined review stages rather than that blanket restriction?

04 • Partner representative: Would you consider exclusivity limited to the proposed field while we assess the data?

05 • Alliance director: We can evaluate that proposal, but the field boundary and duration still need authorized review.

06 • Partner representative: Can we record it as agreed in the term sheet while the reviewers work?

07 • Alliance director: No. Record it as a proposal under discussion, with the open conditions clearly visible.

08 • Partner representative: I'll revise the request and explain which diligence activities need protected time.

09 • Alliance director: We'll assess those activities and return a scoped response rather than promise an unreviewed restriction.

10 • Partner representative: That gives us a concrete negotiation path without treating today's discussion as a completed rights agreement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Data-room access with a staged scope

Separate fictional partnering case: a potential partner requests the entire data room before agreeing the intended diligence questions; sharing scope is unapproved.

01 • Partner scientist: Could you open the entire data room before our team decides which programs to assess?

02 • Business development manager: We can discuss staged access, but the intended diligence questions and sharing scope need agreement first.

03 • Partner scientist: A complete view would help us decide whether to seek an option.

04 • Business development manager: Understood. Could you identify the initial scientific questions so we can propose an appropriately reviewed first set?

05 • Partner scientist: Would receiving that set imply we have priority rights over the programs?

06 • Business development manager: No. Information access and an option or exclusivity commitment are separate matters.

07 • Partner scientist: Then let's discuss an initial reviewed package without treating it as a rights grant.

08 • Business development manager: Agreed, subject to the applicable confidentiality and access review before anything is shared.

09 • Partner scientist: I'll send the question list and identify who needs to participate in the diligence discussion.

10 • Business development manager: I'll coordinate the scoped response and keep further access conditional on the agreed review process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Partnering and Business Development

A potential partner requests exclusive rights before the scope of the collaboration is defined.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: We can discuss exclusivity alongside the proposed scope, responsibilities, and milestones. Could we first clarify which activities and rights you have in mind so the appropriate teams can evaluate the request?

Scenario 2 | A proposed option with no decision trigger

A fictional draft term sheet mentions an option after a research milestone, but does not define the milestone or who confirms it. Hold a negotiation to identify those missing conditions before discussing commitment.

Role A: Business development manager: request a defined milestone and confirmation process.

Role B: Partnering director: explain the need for a usable decision trigger while acknowledging that terms remain proposed.

Possible opening: We can discuss the option structure, but the milestone and confirmation process need to be defined first.

Success checks

- Distinguish a proposed option from an agreed right.
- Clarify the trigger and decision authority without inventing terms.
- Agree the next review step and keep commitment conditional.

Add a complication: The partner asks you to announce the option as secured before those details are reviewed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The finding is promising in this experimental system. We have not established its relevance across diseases. I'll distinguish the current evidence from the broader platform hypothesis.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Assay Development and Reproducibility

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

B: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

C: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

Check 2: B - An increase of one percentage point.

A: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

B: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

C: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

Model response: Within-run consistency and performance across days are different questions. Let's report both and investigate the between-day variation before describing the assay as reproducible under those conditions.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Biomarkers and Translational Strategy

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: What kind of validation do you mean here? Could we distinguish the assay's analytical performance from evidence about the biomarker's clinical use? The slide needs to state which claim the data support.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Preclinical Data Packages

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The result describes the tested animal model and exposure. It does not establish human benefit. I'll state the finding and the limits on translating it to a clinical setting.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | CMC and Scale-Up in Biotech

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The two small runs met the expected yield. Larger-scale performance is still untested. I'll present scale-up as an open question and identify the next planned evidence point.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | IP, Freedom to Operate, and Collaboration

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could the responsible teams confirm the permitted uses and publication terms before the exchange? I'll summarize the scientific purpose and the unresolved questions for review.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Investor and Board Updates

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: I'll group the results around the milestone question: what have we learned, what remains uncertain, and what evidence is needed next? That will make the funding discussion easier to follow.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Partnering and Business Development

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: C - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

B: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

C: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

Check 2: B - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

B: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

C: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

Model response: We can discuss exclusivity alongside the proposed scope, responsibilities, and milestones. Could we first clarify which activities and rights you have in mind so the appropriate teams can evaluate the request?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Biotechnology English

Professional audience: biotech scientists, translational researchers, assay-development teams, platform teams, program managers, alliance managers, business-development staff, and biotech executives

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: Platform Technology and Scientific Thesis

Original fictional case: A platform produces a promising signal in one experimental system. An investor slide says it will work across several diseases.

Language workshop: Match certainty to evidence

Communication goal: Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Language guidance: Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The available evidence shows ... / This may indicate ..., but ... / We have not yet established whether ...

Vocabulary: platform: A foundational technology or system that supports several applications or products. / modality: A type of therapeutic or technological approach, such as a small molecule or cell therapy. / proof of concept: Early evidence that an idea can work under specified conditions. / translatability: Likelihood that a finding in one model, setting, or population will predict results in the intended real-world or clinical setting.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The finding is promising in this experimental system. We have not established its relevance across diseases. I'll distinguish the current evidence from the broader platform hypothesis.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level